



Ubuntu for Android

Android fires a salvo towards Apple with the help of Ubuntu – a friendly version of Linux aimed at the masses
<http://dgit.in/Iras9F>

Matchmaker, matchmaker...

This smartphone features song scanning and matching as well as 50GB free online Dropbox storage
<http://dgit.in/IrcAhI>

30-minute expert: SparkleShare

SparkleShare bridges the gap between a synchronization service and code hosting sites

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SparkleShare is an Open Source file synchronisation software that builds on the power of Git. Unlike services such as Dropbox, it can work with any hosting service for Git.

You may be wondering what all the fuss around Git and GitHub is about. What are these magical tools and services? Let us tell you.

Git and Revision Control

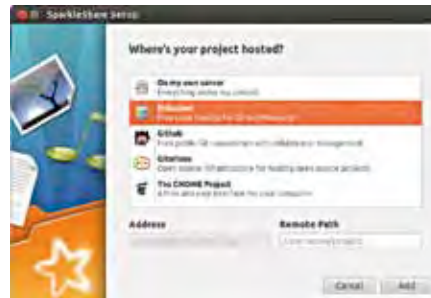
Git is a revision control system, an open source developer tool for managing software code and collaborating with a large number of people. First and foremost, such software allow developers to maintain a history of all the changes made to all files. At any time, you can browse previous snapshots of the code and revert changes. It also provides tools to manage the kind of conflicts that arise when multiple people change the same files.

Sounds cool, doesn't it? While there's nothing stopping you from using it to work with your documents and other data, it could be daunting for non-developers. After all, these tools are designed by developers, for developers.

It could work well as a backend for syncing, if each step of the process didn't need to be done manually via command line. This is where SparkleShare comes in by automating the whole process.

Sync, Revision and SparkleShare

SparkleShare offers a unique mixture of file versioning and syncing. It uses the power of Git to store multiple revisions of your files, and can use services such as GitHub for storage. You can even host your own Git server for maximum



SparkleShare takes a few minutes to synchronize for the first time, especially if the repository isn't empty



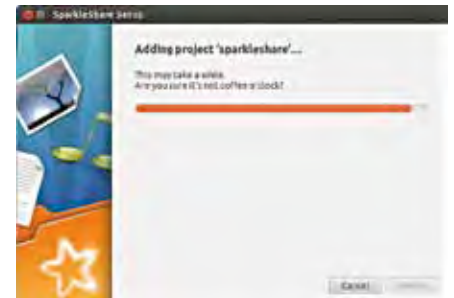
Any Git hosting service should offer this feature. The interface and location might differ though

control over your own data. SparkleShare automatically takes a snapshot of your files when it detects changes and uploads it to the server. If you have two computers linked to the same repository, it will keep both of them in sync. When files on one computer are updated, the other computers are notified, and their copies are updated. For this, it uses a service hosted by SparkleShare, but you can use your own.

Setting up SparkleShare

This is all well and good but you probably want to start using SparkleShare today. Don't worry, you'll be running it soon enough.

For Windows / Mac OSX, the builds of SparkleShare are available on its GitHub page (the Windows version is also included in the DVD). For Linux users, chances are that it's available via your



Adding a new repository to SparkleShare. Set it up on the hosting site first

distro's package manager. To sync your files, you need to be signed up on GitHub, BitBucket or some other source code hosting web service. On whatever service use, create a new repository for your files.

For the purpose of security, SparkleShare generates a key — you can think of this as a long password — that it will use to authenticate. The BitBucket / other hosting service needs to be told what this key is. You can find this key in the SparkleShare folder in your home directory (C:\Users\UserName\SparkleShare\ on Windows). It will be a text file named something like "UserName's key.txt". Open it and copy its contents.

On your hosting service, look for "SSH keys" or something similar in your account configuration panel. Add a new key and paste the contents of the above mentioned file. Now you can start adding repositories to SparkleShare!

Click on the SparkleShare icon and click on "Add Hosted Project..." In the wizard that pops up, select the hosting service you're using and enter the details it asks for. Click "Add", wait for a few minutes, and voila! You now have a folder that's fully synced and maintains a history of every change ever made to it. You can browse the changes and download older versions of the files from the service's web site.

Perhaps SparkleShare isn't the easiest sync software to set up, but once it's set up using it is effortless. It is still in active development, and will surely improve in the future. **[4]**